

Pentatonic Woodwinds Rehearsal Framework

0–5 min — Arrival & Individual Warm-Up

- Setup
- Personal long tones and (optional) chromatic scale
- Individual tuning
- Light articulation

Rehearsal begins formally at minute 5.

5–20 min — Chamber Warm-Up (15 Minutes Total)

1. Unison Tone Center (3 min)

- Sustain one pitch (rotating weekly)
- 8 counts
- Decrescendo to niente
- Re-enter together without conductor

Focus:

- Immediate pitch center
 - Unified tone color
 - Identical release
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2. Scale of the Week (5 min)

- Full range (1–2 octaves as appropriate)
- ♩ = 72, legato
- Once at performance tempo
- Tune tonic chord carefully
- Resolve to dominant → return to tonic

Goal:

- Tone consistency
 - Harmonic awareness
 - Ensemble listening
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3. Blend Exercise (4 min — choose one per rehearsal)

Option A – Chorale Fragment

- Use 4 measures from repertoire
- Slow tempo

- Focus on balance and shaping

Option B – Dynamic Swell

- Sustain chord pp → ff → pp
- Maintain pitch center and tone stability

Option C – Staggered Entry

- Enter same pitch 2 beats apart
 - Match tone color precisely
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4. Articulation Alignment (3 min)

- Take one measure from repertoire
- Play:
 - All slurred
 - All short
 - As written

Goal:

- Identical attack
 - Unified length
 - Clean releases
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20–70 min — Repertoire Work

- Work in focused 10–15 minute sections
 - Address specific issues
 - Re-run immediately after corrections
 - Keep discussion concise
 - (Optional) 2-minute stretch reset if energy drops
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70–85 min — Full Run-Through

- Perform a complete section without stopping
 - Build performance mindset
 - Maintain musical flow
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85–90 min — Closing

- Brief reflection:
 - What improved?
 - What needs attention?
- Assign specific practice goals for next rehearsal
- End on a positive note

Ensemble Captain Responsibilities

The Ensemble Captain:

- Leads scale of the week
- Initiates tuning process
- Counts off repertoire
- Helps maintain rehearsal focus
- Models professional preparation and behavior

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